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Graduate Recruitment Team

Aegon Asset Management

3 Lochside Crescent

Edinburgh EH12 9SA

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the NextGen Traineeship (Investments) in Edinburgh. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Aegon Asset Management's NextGen Traineeship, with rotations across investment and operations teams, capstone projects and mentoring from senior professionals, is a structured way into investing that I can pursue in Edinburgh.

My academic work centres on a question asset managers answer every day: what is a return worth once its risk is understood? I tested CAPM on 704 anomaly portfolios across 56 countries and found it fails jointly in 48 of 52, with momentum and value earning the most persistent alphas. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, and tests whether better risk forecasts improve a volatility-targeted futures strategy, a question that matters to any portfolio with commodity exposure.

Asset management appeals to me because it rewards a process that holds up over years rather than a single good call, and because the money belongs to people relying on that process. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC and published weekly research notes for members from outside finance. That work taught me that a sound view is only half the job; it also has to be explained clearly to the people who rely on it.

Aegon Asset Management stands out to me because its Edinburgh investment teams manage portfolios for clients worldwide, and its traineeship combines rotations with support for a recognised professional qualification. My dissertation and CAPM study have given me a grounding in how returns and risk are measured, and I would like to learn how Aegon's portfolio managers turn that analysis into decisions for clients.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan